

# Installation

Choose the installation guide for the component that owns the task. Install DCGM to operate its host engine, command-line tools, diagnostics, or APIs. Install DCGM Exporter to expose selected DCGM telemetry to Prometheus.

## Choose What to Install

| Installation guides |                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                 |                                       |
|---------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Component           | Provides                                                                                                    | Use it when                                                                                                     | Guide                                 |
| DCGM                | The DCGM host engine, <code>dcgm</code> , libraries, diagnostics, field definitions, and development files. | A host needs DCGM management, health, diagnostics, telemetry, or API access.                                    | <a href="#">Install DCGM</a>          |
| DCGM Exporter       | A Prometheus <code>/metrics</code> endpoint backed by selected DCGM fields.                                 | Prometheus needs GPU, NVSwitch, NVIDIA CPU, or workload-attributed telemetry from a host or Kubernetes cluster. | <a href="#">Install DCGM Exporter</a> |

## How the Components Relate

DCGM Exporter uses DCGM through `libdcgm`. By default, it initializes an embedded DCGM host engine inside the exporter process. It can instead connect to a separately managed DCGM host engine over a supported remote transport.

Exporter releases pair a tested DCGM version with an exporter version. The installation method determines who supplies and manages that DCGM dependency:

- With packages, the system package manager updates DCGM and DCGM Exporter, and systemd manages their services. Keep the package versions paired during upgrades.
- A standalone exporter container carries the DCGM libraries selected for its release. The container image tag owns the pairing and can use embedded or remote operation.
- A Helm release manages the exporter DaemonSet and related Kubernetes resources. Its chart values select the exporter image and version pair.
- NVIDIA GPU Operator manages DCGM, DCGM Exporter, and the surrounding GPU software stack as one Kubernetes lifecycle.

Follow the selected child guide instead of assuming that every exporter deployment requires a separately installed DCGM host engine.

## Shared Prerequisites

Both products require a supported NVIDIA GPU, driver, operating environment, and sufficient access to the GPU devices. Package installation and service changes require administrative privileges. Container deployments also require the NVIDIA Container Toolkit and permission to use the container runtime.

Use the [DCGM product support matrix](#) and the detailed requirements in the selected installation guide before deploying across a fleet.

## Recommended Paths

Recommended installation paths

| Goal                                                                  | Start with                            | Continue with                                                                                                           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Use <code>dcgmi</code> , diagnostics, or the C, C++, or Go interfaces | <a href="#">Install DCGM</a>          | <a href="#">Getting Started for System Administrators</a> or <a href="#">Getting Started for Application Developers</a> |
| Run a package-managed exporter on GPU hosts                           | <a href="#">Install DCGM Exporter</a> | <a href="#">Configure Prometheus for DCGM Exporter</a>                                                                  |
| Run a standalone exporter container                                   | <a href="#">Install DCGM Exporter</a> | <a href="#">DCGM Exporter command reference</a>                                                                         |
| Monitor Kubernetes GPU nodes                                          | <a href="#">Install DCGM Exporter</a> | <a href="#">Configure Prometheus for DCGM Exporter</a>                                                                  |

## Next Steps

- [Getting Started for System Administrators](#) explains the DCGM service and operational model.
- [Configure Prometheus for DCGM Exporter](#) configures Prometheus scraping and target verification.
- [dcgm-exporter](#) defines every exporter startup interface.
- [DCGM Exporter Metrics](#) documents the shipped and exporter-owned metric families.



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